intraregional relationships. There should be no rush to war for any but the gravest reasons, but China's salami-slicing tactics need to be met with greater resolve on the part of the United States and regional nations alike. Beijing may choose to try and force its preferred solutions on its neighbors, but it must understand the political, economic, and potentially even military costs of doing so.

More broadly, the US approach of incentivizing disruptive Chinese behavior by ignoring provocations needs to end. Beijing must be made to recognize that it can no longer take advantage of trading partners or materially harm other nations with impunity. Going forward, US strategy must impose reciprocity in bilateral relations in order to hold the line on China's attempts to undercut US influence, alter norms of conduct, and contravene the spirit of international agreements. As Beijing moderates its behavior, US pressure can ease and tension can abate. The Trump administration has begun to do this, by levying tariffs on Chinese goods, targeting Chinese espionage agents, as well as by increasing US military operations in the South China Sea. There must be a consistent approach, however, across future US administrations of seeking to work with Beijing while immediately responding to cyber espionage, aggression against US forces in international waters and skies, and the intimidation of US partners.

A potentially significant step toward strengthening US policy in the Indo-Pacific was taken with the Asia Reassurance Initiative Act of 2018 (ARIA), signed into law on December 31, 2018. The act is the most comprehensive statement of US interests in Asia in at least a generation, and complements the 2019 Department of Defense *Indo-Pacific Strategy Report*. It was no accident that President Trump signed the ARIA just one day before the fortieth anniversary of the normalization of US-China relations. The act, sponsored by Sens. Cory Gardner (R-CO) and Edward Markey (D-MA), gives support to the administration's belief that China is the greatest global threat to US interests. It authorizes over $7.5 billion through 2023 to enhance US alliance relations, increase arms sales, promote grassroots programs, develop trade, and upgrade ties with India and Taiwan, among other goals.